

Biological Treatments in Abnormal Psychology (PSY404)

Names of Biological Treatments:

1. Drug Therapy (Psychopharmacology)
2. Electroconvulsive Therapy (ECT)
3. Psychosurgery
4. Brain Stimulation Therapies (e.g., rTMS)

Electroconvulsive Therapy (ECT):

Electroconvulsive Therapy is a biological treatment in which a controlled electric current is passed through the brain to produce a brief seizure. It is mainly used for severe depression, especially when medicines do not work or the patient is suicidal.

Procedure:

The patient is given general anesthesia and muscle relaxants before treatment. Electrodes are placed on the head, and a small electric shock is given for a few seconds.

Effectiveness:

ECT improves mood by changing brain chemistry and is considered safe under medical supervision.

Side Effects:

Temporary memory loss, headache, and confusion.